

THE WAR OF ART : Breakthrough the blocks and win your inner creative battles ~ STEVEN PRESSFIELD

- 1) Writing part → Hard X
sitting down to write → Hard ✓ } what keeps us from sitting down
[RESISTANCE]
↳ most toxic force in planet.
↳ repelling force
- 2) Objective Resistance → prevent us from doing our work
- 3) More imp the call/action is to our soul evolution, the more resistance we will feel toward pursuing it.
↳ every1 who has a body → experience Resistance
↳ Resistance target → to kill → our genius, our soul, the unique & priceless gift we were put on earth to give & that no one else has but us.
↳ MASTER THE FEAR AND WE CONQUER RESISTANCE.
- 4) Resistance is most powerful at the finish line.
↳ & at this pt → (R) knows we're about to beat it → it hits the panic button → Be ALERT of this counterattack.
- 5) The best & only thing that 1 artist can do for another is to serve as an example & an inspiration
- 6) Procrastination → most common manifestation of (R)
- 7) NEVER FORGET : This very moment, we ~~can~~ ^{can} change our lives. There never was a moment & never will be. This sec we can turn the tables on (R). This second we can sit down & do our work.
- 8) Anything that draw attention → via pain free → manifestation of (R)
↳ VICTIMHOOD → Don't cast myself as victim of doing your work if you're doing it, STOP.

- 9) The Truly Free individual is free only to the extent only to the extent of his own-self mastery. While those who will not govern themselves are condemned to find masters to govern them.
- 10) Individuals who are realized in their own lives almost never criticize others. If they speak at all, it is to offer encouragement. WATCH YOURSELF. Criticism & jealousy harm others as well.
- 11) Fear is good. It is an indicator. "The more scared we are of a work or calling, the more sure we can be that we have to do it."
- 12) THE PROFESSIONAL → tackles the project that will make him stretch. takes assignment that will bear him to explore unconscious parts of himself.
- 13) If you're paralyzed with fear, it's a good sign. It shows what you have to do.
- 14) Resistance & Love → The more @ you experience, the more important your art/project/enterprise is to you and the more gratification you will feel when you finally do it.
- 15) THE PROFESSIONALS → learned that success, like happiness, comes as a by-product of work.
↳ They concentrate on the work & allows rewards to come or not come, whatever they like.
- 16) "I need to complete his healing before he is ready to do his work"
↳ This way of thinking is a form of Resistance
- 17) The more troubles we've got, the better & richer that part becomes
↳ "What counted was that I had, after years of running from it, actually sat down & done my work."
- 18) SEEKING SUPPORT FROM FRIENDS & FAMILY → Nice!
↳ but when the ship sails, all they can do is stand on the dock waving goodbye.
↳ The more energy we spend stoking up on support from colleagues & loved ones, the weaker we become & less capable of handling our business.
- 19) when your deeper self delivers a dream → don't talk about it. Don't debate its power. The dream is for you. it's b/w you & our muse. Shut up & use it.

- 20) Resistance is fear → it brings Rationalization → instead of showing us our fear, it presents us with a series of plausible, rational justifications for why we shouldn't do our work.
- 21) THE PROFESSIONAL loves it so much he dedicates his life to it. He commits full time. → That's what I mean
(R) → hates → (PRO) (turning) Turning a PRO
- 22) PRO → 'I write when inspiration strikes', fortunately it strikes everyday 9-10 o'clock.
↓
I despise (R); I will not let it faze me; I will sit down & do my work.
- 23) DEEPER TRUTH → by performing the mundane, ^{physical} act of sitting down & starting to work → set in motion a mysterious, but infallible sequence of events that would produce inspiration.
- 24) PRINCIPLE OF PRIORITY
a) you must know the difference b/w what is urgent & what's imp
b) You must do what's important first.
WHAT'S IMP IS THE WORK
- 25) "An hour passes, I'm warmer now, the pale has got my blood going."
- 26) Artist committing himself → dire for deviation on a diet of isolation, rejection, self doubt, despair, ridicule, contempt & humiliation.
He has to know how to be miserable.
He has to love being miserable.
- 27) Amateur → overly invested in its success & overtrifled on failure
↳ 1. He doesn't show up everyday
2. He doesn't show up no matter what.
3. He is not committed over the long haul
4. He doesn't have a sense of humor regarding failure.
5. He doesn't write his trilogy at all.
- 28) NOTHING IS EMPOWERING AS REAL-WORLD VALIDATION.
- 29) PROFESSIONAL → accepts money → but do it out of love. He has to love it, otherwise he won't devote his life to it.
- 30) also learned → that too much love can be a bad thing.

31) More you love your art/calling/enterprise → more you fear it → more you resist it → to the evolution of your soul.
↓
more you fear it → more resistance

32) The payoff of playing the game for money is not the money.

↳ it actually produces proper professional attitude.

↳ The professional takes money. The pro plays for pay. But in the end, he does it for love.

33) Professional → is Patient → understands DELAYED GRATIFICATION.

↳ knows any job → twice as long as he thinks & costs twice as much.

He accepts it, He recognizes it as reality.

↳ He conserves his energy. Prepares his mind for long haul.

↳ He masters HOW & leaves what & why to the gods.

↳ Professional shuts up. She doesn't talk about it. She does her work.

34) Amateur → believes → he'll first overcome his fear then he can do his work. The prof → knows fear can't be overcome. He knows that

there is no such thing as a fearless warrior.

35) Prof → prepared at deeper level → to confront his own self-sabotage

→ his goal → victory X (success will come by itself when

↳ to handle himself it wants to)

A PROF DOES NOT SHOW OFF

↳ his work has style → he doesn't impose it as a means of drawing attention to himself.

A PROF DEDICATES HIMSELF TO MASTERING TECHQ.

↳ not afraid to ASK for help.

↳ doesn't take failure or success personally.

if prof takes rejection personally → induces resistance.

NO MATTER WHAT I'LL NEVER LET @ BEAT ME

PROF GIVES AN EAR TO CRITICISM, SEEKING TO LEARN & GROW.

36) Humiliation (rejection/criticism) → external deflection of @

PROF ENDURES ADVERSITY

↳ cannot allow the actions of others to define his reality. Nothing matters but that he keep working.

PROF RECOGNIZES HER LIMITATIONS → being in other pros & treats 'em with respect.

37) A PROF IS RECOGNIZED BY other PROF.
↳ Reinvents himself → doesn't permit himself to bend in form

38) YOU, INC. → making myself a corporation reinforces the idea of professionalism

I've one of those meetings with myself every Monday. Then I type it up & distribute it to myself. ↳ gives us healthy a healthy distance on ourselves

As PMJ, Inc., I can pump the hell out of myself. I'm not me anymore. I'm Me Inc. I'm a pro.

39) "They believed that if they did their work, no force on earth could stand against 'em'".

40) There's no negativity to turning pro. It's a decision brought about by an act of will. We make up our mind to view ourselves as pro & we do it. Simple as that

BEYOND RESISTANCE

1) Most imp thing about ART → is to work.

"Nothing else matters except sitting down everyday & trying"

Unseen force → reinforces → our purpose → when we sit down day after day & keep grinding.

When we sit down & work

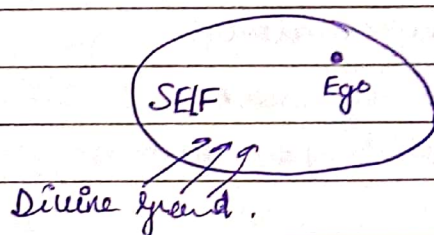
↳ we become like → MAGNETISED ROD → ideas come insights accrete.

2) The moment one commits oneself → all things occur to help one that would not otherwise have occurred

3) Whatever you can do, or dream you can, begin it.
Boldness has genius, magic & power in it. Begin it now.

4) Some intelligence is at work, independent of our conscious mind & yet in alliance with it, procures our material for us & alongside us.

5) Unseen intelligence → guides always.



Ego → part of psyche that we think of as "I".

Self → ego + personal & collective unconscious.

The moment when we learn
we may soon die

→ state of conscious moves from Ego to Self.
The world is entirely new, viewed from self.

Self → wishes to create, to evolve; Ego → likes the things as they are.

The more awake we become → the less we need the Ego.

The ego hates it when the awakening writer sits down at the typewriter.

6) Resistance feels on fear. We experience resistance as fear.

Fear of the consequences of following our heart.

Fear that we will succeed → that we can access the powers we secretly know we possess.

We fear discovering that we are more than we think we are.

We fear that we actually possess the talent that our still, small voice tells us.

7) Our job → not to shape ourselves into some ideal we imagine we ought to be → but to find out who we actually are & become it.

8) WE CAME TO THIS WORLD WITH PERSONAL DESTINY.

- 9) The artist can't look to others to validate his efforts/calling.
↳ must operate territorially → he must do his work for his sake
↳ must look within.
- 10) I trusted what I wanted, not what I thought would work.
I did what I, myself thought ~~would work~~, was interesting & left its reception to the gods.

11) THE TERRITORIAL ORIENTATION

- ↳ when I sit down & write, I'm on my territory.
↳ our role in territory is to put in efforts & love; the territory rewards it & give it back to us in the form of well being.
↳ A territory can only be claimed alone.
↳ by work.
↳ A territory returns exactly what you put in.

12) We are seeking the good opinion of others.

13) of any activity you do: Ask myself: if I were the last person on planet would I do it?

Hierarchical orientation makes no sense.

↳ there's no 1 to impress.

The sustenance (source of strength) ~~goes~~ comes from the act itself, not from the impression it makes on others.

14) We must do our work for its own sake, not for further attention or applause.

15) The enemy of the artist is the small time Ego, which begs (R)
↳ An artist must be a warrior & like all warriors, artists over time acquire modesty & humility.

In the end ~~quest~~ ← THE ARTIST'S LIFE

can only come by ACTION

DO IT OR DON'T DO IT

↳ Creative work is not a selfish act or bid for attention. It's a gift to the world & every being in it. Don't cheat us of our contribution. Give us what you get.